than the common or the third class, and the Asthi Special (the train carrying the urn with his ashes), ferrying the mortal remains for submersion in the holy confluence of rivers at Prayag in Allahabad also comprised five third class carriages.

The urn was placed in the middle carriage, heavily covered in flowers and khadi flags and illuminated by six electric lights, and so clearly visible to spectators from the platform. Large images of the charkha and Ashoka's national lion seal were painted on the carriage.

The train left Delhi at 4 a.m. on 11 February 1948. The urn with Gandhiji's ashes and bones was looked after and guarded during the journey by Abha, Manu, Pyarelal, Dr Sushila Nayyar, Prabhavati Narayan and others who were Gandhiji's daily companions at prayer. The train stopped at eleven stations en route where millions paid their homage. Many sobbed, others wept bitterly. The special train reached Allahabad on 12 February where the urn was placed on a miniature wooden palanquin and placed on a motor truck, and the cortège proceeded for the obsequies among the throng of an estimated 1.5 million mourners. [12 6]

THE PARTITION: DEATH TRAINS ON THE SPLIT SUBCONTINENT

The most painful part of the history of the Indian subcontinent is probably the Partition and its related trauma. The Partition of India on 15 August burdened the two new railways into which the old north-western system was divided—the Pakistan NWR and the Indian Eastern Punjab Railway. The situation has been documented in *The Railway Gazette* :

A programme of special personnel and baggage trains had been arranged to transfer those officials of the old Government of India in Delhi who had elected to serve in Pakistan, to Karachi, the capital of Pakistan, and for several days this programme worked smoothly. Then, however, it was interrupted rudely by the mining, derailment and subsequent attack on one of these specials while passing through eastern Punjab. Though trains were diverted immediately to another route and one or two got through without molestation, the whole situation on both sides of the border by this time had got out of hand, and the movement by rail of the Pakistan government personnel had to be cancelled.

At a later date, some members of this staff and their families were sent, however, from Delhi by the Bombay, Baroda and Central India Railway metre gauge line to Marwar Junction, and thence by the Jodhpur Railway to Hyderabad (Sind), on the NWR main line, over which they completed the journey to Karachi. This arrangement worked well, for a time, until the disturbances spread to the Delhi area, when this route also became unsafe. As no land route remained available, the remaining 5,000 officials and their families were flown in twenty-five aircraft, chartered from BOAC, operating an intensive shuttle service between Delhi and Karachi.

Attacks on Trains and Fuel Shortage

Meanwhile, communal disturbances in Lahore seriously affected the attendance of railway staff. The immediate effect was the cancellation of trains for want of crews. Communal trouble also spread to rural areas, where trains were stopped and attacked, and men, women